The Daimabad Charioteer (with detail), part of a cache of four bronzes unearthed outside the village of Daimabad in Maharashtra in 1974, now in the National Museum in New Delhi. The man is ithyphallic, or in a state of sexual arousal. The oxen have horns and humps but also horse-like features.

If the Daimabad bronzes are indeed from the early Malwa phase – and even that is a big if, since they could well date from much later – then they are very special indeed, because nothing like them has so far emerged from any post-Harappan site. Rhinos, buffalo and elephants are all well represented on Harappan seals and as terracotta toys, but not so the friendly dog, which is a crucial tool in the hunter's and the herdsman's portfolio. Then there is that chariot, a vehicle unknown on Harappan art. It has been suggested that what is represented here is bull-racing, a traditional post-harvest sport known as *khurak* that still takes place in some rural areas of Maharashtra. But this takes no account of the charioteer with his bizarre cobra-head erection. He is no toy, nor is he an ordinary mortal, which suggests that he represents a priapic god. He may well represent a key moment of transition between two very different cultures: the old settled urban culture of the Harappans, who left behind a mass of evidence in the form of buildings, terracotta artefacts and seals, and a new, shifting culture that left virtually nothing tangible other than firepits, wooden post-holes, potsherds and just enough in the way of arrow- and spear-heads and slag heaps to show that its people had entered the Iron Age. It is as if the people who made them had better or more important things to think about.[11]

So strikingly different are these two cultures, the old and the new, that it is as if there were two quite different peoples. But that is not how some people see it. They are the proponents of the 'out of India' theory, which argues that there never was a collapse in the Harappan Civilisation, only a decline followed by a resurgence that developed into